Construction of ovoid coordinate systems and ovoid spacetimes

Juan A. Guarín-Rojas*

Escuela de Física, Universidad Industrial de Santander, CP 680002, Bucaramanga, Colombia.

Antonio C. Gutiérrez-Piñeres†

Escuela de Física, Universidad Industrial de Santander,

CP 680002, Bucaramanga, Colombia and

Instituto de Ciencias Nucleares, Universidad Nacional Autónoma de México,

AP 70543, México, CDMX 04510, México

Rafael Torres‡

Escuela de Física, Universidad Industrial de Santander, CP 680002, Bucaramanga, Colombia

(Dated: August 15, 2026)

In this work, some Cartesian ovoid coordinates are constructed to aid the description of ovoid spacetimes. In optics, Cartesian ovoids are useful to construct optical systems free of both geometric and chromatic aberrations. In astrophysics, these ovoids may be useful for describing objects with mass quadrupoles, such as merging binary stars. To construct ovoid coordinates, two special families of ovals are considered: confocal and triconfocal ovals. In the first family, the ovals share two foci, and in the second, they share three. For each family, the set of curves that intersect the ovals at right angles is obtained. Then, some 2D coordinates are derived from these families of curves. These coordinates are extended to 3D, yielding cylindrical and rotational-like coordinates. From the Euclidean line element in ovoid coordinates, a metric ansatz for describing a stationary ovoid spacetime is proposed. This ansatz is used to obtain an exact solution of the Einstein field equations for a static anisotropic fluid.

*Electronic address: juan2201870@correo.uis.edu.co

†Electronic address: acgutier@uis.edu.co

‡Electronic address: rafael.torres@saber.uis.edu.co

I. INTRODUCTION

Cartesian ovoids are quartic surfaces that have been proven to be useful in optics. They were found as a solution to the problem of rigorous stigmatism [1], in which light rays emitted from a point source must be refracted or reflected to a single point by an optical surface, which turns out to be a Cartesian ovoid [2, 3]. In a plane containing the focal axis, one obtains a Cartesian oval as the intersection curve between the ovoid and the plane. In recent years, Cartesian ovoids have been recovered by Silva-Lora and Torres [4–6]. These authors use ovoids to construct singlet lenses with aplanatism and compound lenses with achromatic stigmatism, i.e., stigmatic systems free of chromatic aberration. These promising results show the importance of ovoids in optics.

Ovoids can also be considered as a specialization of the family of superconic surfaces [7–9]. These surfaces satisfy an algebraic equation of nth degree that generalizes the Schwarzschild equation for conic surfaces[1] [9, 10]. Ovoids are also close to conic surfaces in that their respective generatrices, ovals and conic sections, both have foci. However, ovals have three foci [11–13]. When one of the foci goes to infinity, the Cartesian ovals become conic sections [11, 13], or a portion of them, and when the third focus coincides with the first or the second, they become limaçons of Pascal [13]. In this way, ovoids generalize conic surfaces.

In general relativity, symmetries are key to simplifying the description of spacetimes. The most common symmetries used to model astrophysical objects are spherical and axial symmetry. Models with these symmetries are widely found in the literature [14–17]. Within axially symmetric spacetimes, there are the ellipsoidal spacetimes formulated by Krasiński [18]. Based on Krasiński's ansatz, new and known solutions to the Einstein field equations have been recovered [19–21]. Hence, spherical and ellipsoidal symmetry are useful to construct spacetimes in general relativity.

Since spheres and ellipsoids are special cases of Cartesian ovoids, one wonders if ovoids can also be useful to construct spacetimes in general relativity. As ovoids resemble deformed spheres, an astrophysical object with this shape must have a mass quadrupole. This quadrupole would allow the object to emit gravitational waves in a perturbative regime [22]. Then, ovoids might be useful to describe the gravitational waves emitted by binary neutron

[1] Conic surfaces refer to the surfaces of revolution of conic sections.

stars during merger because, as the stars coalesce, they get deformed, with one star adopting a pear shape that could be modeled using an ovoid.

Optics has a key connection to general relativity. Considering that the speed of light is the same for all observers and that light moves along null geodesics is one of the central ideas of both general and special relativity. Null geodesics also play a key role in characterizing spacetime metrics, as in the Petrov and Segre classifications. Since ovoids are important in optics, one wonders if they can be useful in general relativity. Perhaps an ovoid spacetime can be used to model a stigmatic gravitational lens, thus leading to a theory of optical aberrations for gravitational lenses.

The purpose of this work is to construct some ovoid spacetimes as candidates to model the gravitational field of an ovoid-shaped object. To that end, Sections II-IV introduce Cartesian ovals and ovoid coordinates. In Section II, Cartesian ovals are treated as three-foci curves, and their existence condition is derived. Section III presents confocal and triconfocal ovals, and their respective orthogonal curves. Based on these curves, Section IV formulates and characterizes ovoid coordinate systems. The transformation rules between ovoid and Cartesian coordinates, together with the line element in the new coordinates, are also obtained in the same section.

In general relativity, symmetry can be described in terms of isometry groups and geometric invariants such as Killing vectors [23]. This description applies to spherical, axial, and time-translation symmetries. To extend the notion of symmetry, Krasiński's pioneering work [18] defines ellipsoidal spacetimes in terms of a congruence of observers and the induced metric. Whether isometries or Killing vectors can characterize these spacetimes remains an open question. Based on Krasiński's ideas, Section V defines ovoid spacetimes using the induced metric on confocal ovoids. In Section VI, exact solutions to the Einstein field equations for a static anisotropic fluid in an ovoid spacetime are obtained.

II. CARTESIAN OVALS

A. Cartesian ovals as a three foci curve

A Cartesian oval is the locus of points M such that $c\overline{MF} + c'\overline{MF'}$ is constant, where $\overline{MF} \equiv r$ and $\overline{MF'} \equiv r'$ are the distances from M to two fixed points F and F', called foci,

and c and c' are real constants [12, 13]. Since c and c' cannot both be zero, one can assume $c \neq 0$ without loss of generality. Hence, the equation satisfied by Cartesian ovals can be written as

$$r + ar' = u\,, \tag{1}$$

where a and u are real constants.

For any oval with known foci F and F', there exists a third point F'' such that the oval satisfies an analog of equation 1 of the form $r + \sigma r'' = \delta$, where r and r'' are the distances from M to F and F'', and σ and δ are real constants. This point lies on the line through F and F' and is called the third focus. The existence of this point was first noted by Chasles [11], as shown in Note XXI. In [11, 12], geometric constructions are used to obtain the third focus. Here, an algebraic approach that recovers the results of [13] is presented.

To determine the position of the third focus, consider an xy-coordinate system centered at F with F' at $(\tau, 0)$, as shown in Fig. 5. Allow τ to be either positive or negative. In this coordinate system, equation 1 can be written as

$$\sqrt{x^2 + y^2} + a\sqrt{(x-\tau)^2 + y^2} = u\,, \tag{2}$$

which in polar coordinates becomes $r + \sqrt{r^2 - 2r\tau\cos\theta + \tau^2} = u$. Consider a point F'' located at $(\tau + \xi, 0)$, where $\xi \in \mathbb{R}$. By definition, the distance from M to F'' is

$$r'' = \sqrt{(x-\tau-\xi)^2 + y^2}\,, \tag{3}$$

$$= \sqrt{r^2 - 2r(\tau+\xi)\cos\theta + (\tau+\xi)^2}\,, \tag{4}$$

From the last equation, one obtains $-2r\tau\cos\theta = \tau(r''^2 - r^2 - (\tau+\xi)^2)/(\tau+\xi)$. Hence, equation 2 in polar coordinates becomes

$$r + \sqrt{r^2 + \frac{\tau}{\tau+\xi}(r''^2 - r^2 - (\tau+\xi)^2) + \tau^2} = u\,. \tag{5}$$

This equation can be solved for r''^2, yielding

$$r''^2 = \frac{(u-r)^2(\tau+\xi)}{a^2\tau} + (\tau+\xi)\xi - \frac{r^2\xi}{\tau}\,. \tag{6}$$

Now, one can group the terms in r and complete the square on the right-hand side of this equation as

$$r''^2 = \frac{1}{a^2\tau}\left(\tau + (1-a^2)\xi\right)\left(r - \frac{u(\tau+\xi)}{\tau + (1-a^2)\xi}\right)^2 + \frac{\xi(\xi+\tau)}{\xi + \tau/(1-a^2)}\left(\xi - \frac{u^2-\tau^2}{(1-a^2)\tau}\right)\,. \tag{7}$$

The second term in the right-hand side of this equation is zero when $\xi = 0$, $\xi = -\tau$, or $\xi = \frac{u^2-\tau^2}{(1-a^2)\tau}$. For these values of ξ, equation 7 can be written as a linear equation in r'' and r. Replacing ξ with 0, $-\tau$, and $\frac{u^2-\tau^2}{(1-a^2)\tau}$, equation 7 becomes, respectively,

$$r''^2 = \frac{(u-r)^2}{a^2}\,, \tag{8}$$

$$r''^2 = r^2\,, \tag{9}$$

$$r''^2 = \frac{u^2}{a^2\tau^2}\left(r - \frac{u^2 - a^2\tau^2}{u(1-a^2)}\right)^2\,. \tag{10}$$

Thus, the known cases are recovered, and one new result is obtained. The first case, $\xi = 0$, corresponds to F'' coinciding with F', while the second, $\xi = -\tau$, corresponds to F'' coinciding with F. The third case is the only genuinely new result. In this case, F'' is located at $(\frac{u^2-a^2\tau^2}{(1-a^2)\tau}, 0)$ and from equation 10, it follows that

$$r'' = \pm\frac{u}{a\tau}\left(r - \frac{u^2 - a^2\tau^2}{u(1-a^2)}\right) \tag{11}$$

By convention, the expression for ξ is henceforth fixed as

$$\xi = \frac{u^2 - \tau^2}{(1-a^2)\tau}\,. \tag{12}$$

Equation 11 has the form $r'' = \pm c_1(r - c_2)$, where c_1 and c_2 are constants. The $\pm$ sign must be replaced with the sign of $-\tau(1-a^2)$ so that the resulting curve coincides with the curve defined by equation 1, as one can verify using a plotting software. The resulting linear equation in r and r'' is therefore

$$\mathrm{sign}(\tau(1-a^2))ar'' + \frac{u}{\tau}r = (\tau + \xi)\,, \tag{13}$$

where $\mathrm{sign}(x) := x/|x|$ is the sign function and ξ is given by equation 12. Substituting r from equation 1, this equation becomes

$$\mathrm{sign}(\tau(1-a^2))r'' - \frac{u}{\tau}r' = a\xi\,. \tag{14}$$

Equations 1, 13, and 14 are the so-called bipolar equations for the Cartesian oval [13].

The equations presented here for finding the third focus are equivalent to those in [13]. The authors considered it worthwhile to revisit Johnson's results using modern, clean notation.

B. Existence condition for ovals

In [24], Quelet first noted that Cartesian ovals can be obtained by intersecting two cones with parallel axes. From equation 2, it is clear that Cartesian ovals can be obtained from the intersection curve of the cones defined by

$$z = \sqrt{x^2 + y^2}\,, \tag{15}$$

$$z = u - a\sqrt{(x-\tau)^2 + y^2}\,. \tag{16}$$

Let the first cone be the fixed cone (FC) and the second the movable cone (MC). The values of u, a, and τ determine the apex location and apex angle of the MC. For certain values of these constants, the two cones may not intersect. In such cases, the curve is said to be empty, i.e., that no point satisfies equation 2.

Hence, by analyzing when the cones intersect each other, one can obtain the condition on u, a and τ such that the curve defined by equation 2 is nonempty. This analysis can be divided into three main cases, $|a| < 1$, $a > 1$ and $a < -1$, and two limit cases, $a = \pm 1$. For $|a| < 1$, the cones intersect if the z-intercept of the MC is at or above the origin, as shown in Fig. 1. This implies $u - a|\tau| \geq 0$. For $a > 1$, the cones intersect if the apex of the MC is at or above the FC, as shown in Fig. 2. Thus, one needs $u \geq |\tau|$ in this case. Conversely, for $a < -1$, the cones intersect if the apex of the MC is at or below the FC, as shown in Fig. 2. Then, one must have $u \leq |\tau|$.

In the limiting cases $a = \pm 1$, the two cones have the same apex angle of $\pi/2$. For $a = 1$, the cones open in opposite directions. In this case, the apex and the z-intercept of the MC are both at or above the FC when $u \geq |\tau|$. This is the existence condition for $a = -1$. In the other case, $a = -1$, two conditions are required: the MC's apex must be at or below the FC, and the MC's z-intercept must be at or above the origin. This translates to $-|\tau| \leq u \leq |\tau|$.

The existence condition for Cartesian ovals can be summarized as follows

$$u \geq \min(1, a)|\tau|, \qquad \text{if } a > -1; \tag{17}$$

$$u \leq |\tau|, \qquad \text{if } a < -1; \tag{18}$$

$$-|\tau| \leq u \leq |\tau|, \qquad \text{if } a = -1\,, \tag{19}$$

where $\min(x, y)$ is the minimum of x and y. As far as the authors know, the existence conditions 17-19 do not appear in the literature. Nevertheless, one can argue that they are

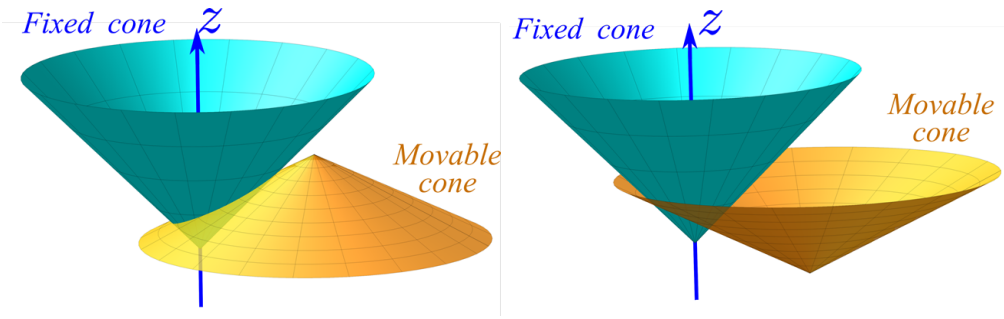


FIG. 1: The fixed cone (FC) and the movable cone (MC) for the cases $0 < a < 1$ and $-1 < a < 0$. On the left, $a = 1/2$ and $u = 0.85$; on the right, $a = -1/2$ and $u = -0.3$. In both cases, $\tau = 1$. Because of the form of the cones, the intersection curve exists if the MC's z-intercept is at or above the origin.

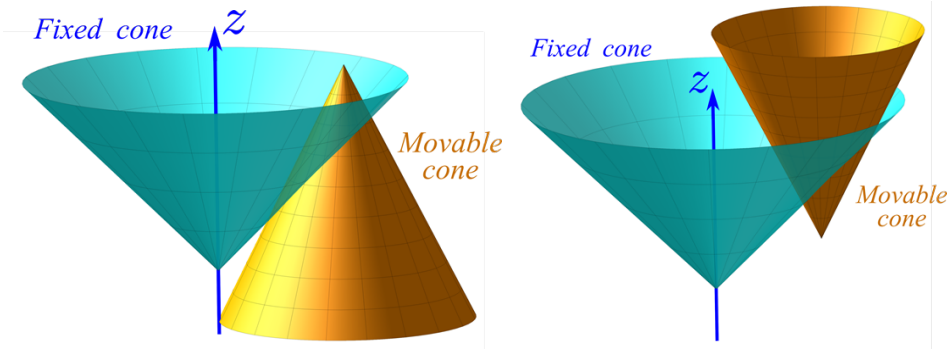


FIG. 2: The fixed cone (FC) and the movable cone (MC) for the cases $a > 1$ and $a < -1$. On the left, $a = 2$ and $u = 1.6$; on the right, $a = -2$ and $u = 0.5$. In both cases, $\tau = 1$. The condition for the cones to intersect depends only on the MC's apex location.

implicit in the work of Descartes [2], and they are mentioned by R. Ferréol on his math blog [25]. At the time of writing this article, only the condition 17 for $a > -1$ coincides with the one in [25].

III. TWO REMARKABLE FAMILIES OF OVALS AND THEIR RESPECTIVE ORTHOGONAL CURVES

This section describes two families of Cartesian ovals that will be used to construct orthogonal coordinates. For each family, $\mathfrak{F}$, a second family of curves, $\mathfrak{G}$, will be obtained so that the members of $\mathfrak{F}$ intersect those of $\mathfrak{G}$ at right angles. The resulting pairs of families,

such as $\mathfrak{F}$ and $\mathfrak{G}$, produce a coordinate grid with right angles at each vertex. This allows the construction of an orthogonal coordinate system, as will be shown in Section IV.

The members of each family are characterized by the value of a parameter u_i, so each vertex on the grid is labeled with a pair (u_1, u_2). The relations between this pair of values and the xy-coordinates of the vertex, (x, y), with respect to a given xy-coordinate system are derived in each subsection. These relations will provide the coordinate transformations between the rectangular and the new coordinates.

A. Confocal ovals and synecdolas

Consider the family of level curves of the function f defined by

$$f(x, y) = \sqrt{x^2 + y^2} + a\sqrt{(x - \tau)^2 + y^2}\,, \tag{20}$$

where a and τ are fixed constants. These level curves are ovals with the same focal distance $|\tau|$ and the same value of a. Hence, they can be called *confocal ovals* or, more precisely, *biconfocal ovals* since they share the same two of the three foci. Here, they are referred to simply as confocal ovals. The level curves satisfy the equation $f(x, y) = u$, where u is a constant. As the value of u varies, the curves cover the entire xy-plane, as shown in Fig. 3. The quantity u may take only values that satisfy one of the existence conditions for ovals 17-19, depending on the value of a.

Consider the problem of finding the curves orthogonal to confocal ovals. Since the gradient of f is composed of vectors orthogonal to the level curves of f, the orthogonal curves must have tangent vectors aligned with ∇f. Considering orthogonal curves described by $y = y(x)$, this condition implies

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = \frac{f_x}{f_y}\,, \tag{21}$$

where the subscripts in f denote partial derivatives. This equation can be written as an inexact differential equation, $f_y dx - f_x dy = 0$. However, it can be made exact by the integrating factor $w = 1/y$, so that $(f_y/y)dx - (f_x/y)dy = 0$ is exact. The implicit solution of this differential equation is

$$\operatorname{arcsinh}\left(\frac{x}{y}\right) + a \operatorname{arcsinh}\left(\frac{x - \tau}{y}\right) = v\,, \tag{22}$$

where v is a real constant. Let g be a function with $g(x, y)$ defined as the left-hand side of this equation. The set of level curves of g will be called synecdolas. These curves intersect each

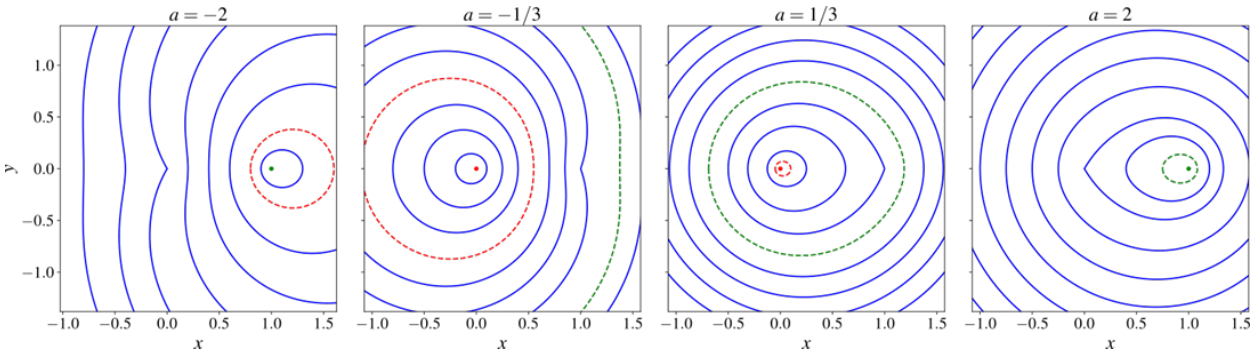


FIG. 3: Level curves of f for different values of a with $\tau = 1$. These curves correspond to confocal ovals. The subfigures show the four characteristic sets of confocal ovals for $a \in (-\infty, -1)$, $a \in (-1, 0)$, $a \in (0, 1)$, and $a \in (1, \infty)$, in order from left to right. All subfigures share the same y-axis limits. Some ovals are colored to illustrate how they change as a varies; the red one corresponds to $u = 0.4$, while the green one corresponds to $u = 1.25$.

confocal oval at a right angle. For $a = 1$, synecdolas become sections of hyperbolas, and for $a = -1$ they become the upper or lower halves of ellipses. In Figure 4, some synecdolas are plotted for $a = 1/2$. The term *synecdola* derives from the figure of speech "synecdoche". The term was coined inspired by the similarity between the names of conic sections and figures of speech, such as circle and circumlocution, ellipse and ellipsis, hyperbola and hyperbole, and parabola and parable.

Synecdolas and confocal ovals form a pair of families whose curves intersect at right angles. The inverse relations $x = x(u, v)$ and $y = y(u, v)$, obtained by solving the equations $f(x, y) = u$ and $g(x, y) = v$ for x and y, will provide the relations between Cartesian coordinates and the new coordinates. To obtain the inverse relations, consider the substitutions

$$x = \frac{\tau \sinh t}{\sinh t - \sinh\left(\frac{v-\tau}{a}\right)}\,, \tag{23}$$

$$y = \frac{\tau}{\sinh t - \sinh\left(\frac{v-\tau}{a}\right)}\,, \tag{24}$$

These equations correspond to the parametric equations for the synecdola. Substituting them into $g(x, y) = v$ yields $v = v$, so the equation is automatically satisfied. The remaining equation, $f(x, y) = u$, becomes

$$\frac{|\tau|\left(\cosh t + a\cosh\left(\frac{v-t}{a}\right)\right)}{\left|\sinh t - \sinh\left(\frac{v-t}{a}\right)\right|} = u\,. \tag{25}$$

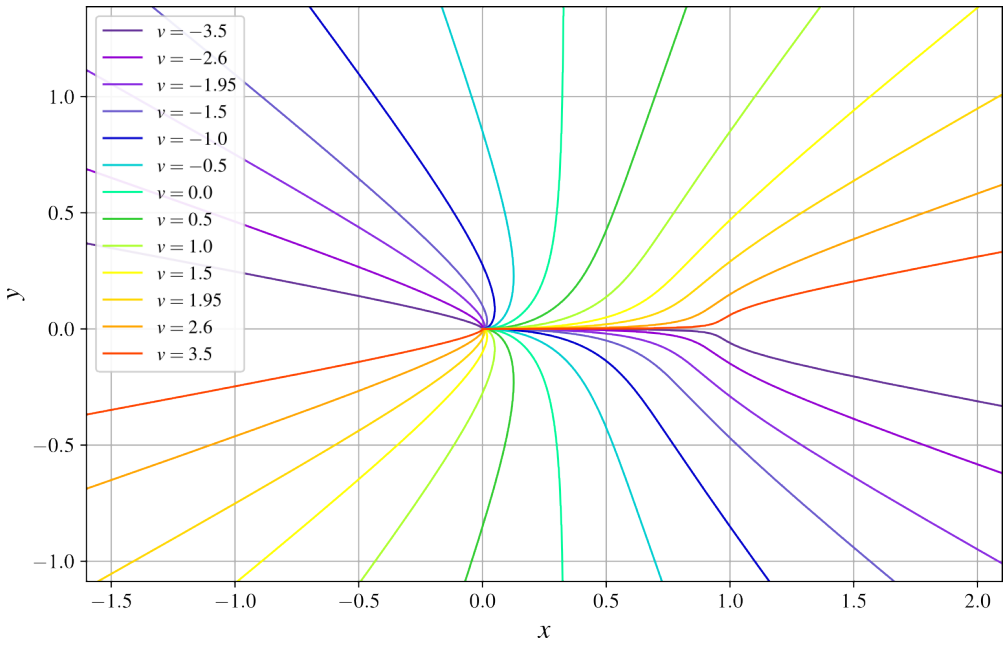


FIG. 4: Synecdolas for $a = 1/2$, $\tau = 1$, and various values of v. These curves resemble confocal hyperbolas. Each synecdola consists of two branches that meet at the origin and converge asymptotically to a straight line at infinity.

The expression in absolute value coincides with $|y|$, where y is taken from equation 24. Hence, by considering inverse relations with $y = y(u, v) > 0$, the absolute value can be eliminated, and equation 25 can be rearranged as

$$(a\tau - u)s^{\frac{2}{a}} + e^{\frac{v}{a}}(\tau - u)s^{\frac{1}{a}+1} + e^{\frac{v}{a}}(\tau + u)s^{\frac{1}{a}-1} + e^{\frac{2v}{a}}(a\tau + u) = 0\,, \tag{26}$$

where $s = e^t$. For $a \in \mathbb{Q}$, this equation can be expressed as an algebraic equation of a certain degree, as shown in Appendix VIII A. For $a = 1/3$, it becomes a cubic in s^2 whose positive real solution for s is

$$s = \sqrt{\alpha_+^{\frac{1}{3}} + \alpha_-^{\frac{1}{3}} - \frac{(\tau - u)e^{3v}}{\tau - 3u}}\,, \tag{27}$$

where

$$\begin{aligned}\alpha_\pm = \pm\, &\frac{e^{\frac{9v}{2}}}{(\tau - 3u)^2}\sqrt{\left[(\tau + 3u)(\tau - u)^3 e^{3v} - (\tau - 3u)(\tau + u)^3\right]\left(e^{3v} - 1\right)} \\ &- \frac{e^{6v}}{(\tau - 3u)^3}\left[(\tau - u)^3 e^{3v} - (\tau - 3u)(\tau^2 + 3u^2)\right]\,.\end{aligned} \tag{28}$$

Substituting equation 27 into equations 23 and 24 with $t = \ln s$ yields the desired relations $x = x(u, y)$ and $y = y(u, v)$. In Appendix VIII B, it is shown that the solution given

by equation 27 is the unique positive solution for s. In particular, it is shown that the expression under the square root in equation 27 is positive when $v \in \mathbb{R}$ and when u satisfies the existence condition for ovals, namely $u \geq |\tau|/3$.

B. Triconfocal ovals

Section II showed that Cartesian ovals can be related to three special points called foci. Given two foci and the values of a and u, the position of the third focus can be obtained from equation 12. Alternatively, if the three foci are known, the value of a or u can be obtained up to a sign from the same equation. Knowledge of the three foci and one point M determines two possible values of both a and u from equations 1 and 12, which determine two Cartesian ovals. Thus, through any point, two ovals can be drawn having the same three foci. This procedure to construct ovals is used in this subsection to obtain two families of ovals that intersect at right angles.

As it was said, equation 1 relates ξ to the other parameters of the oval. From this equation, one can solve for u so that equation 1 becomes

$$r + ar' = \pm\sqrt{\xi\tau(1-a^2)+\tau^2}\,. \tag{29}$$

Squaring both sides and solving for a yields $a = (-rr' \pm \tau r'')/(r'^2 + \xi\tau)$. Based on this equation, let α and β be defined as

$$\alpha = \frac{-\sqrt{x^2+y^2}\sqrt{(x-\tau)^2+y^2}+\tau\sqrt{(x-\tau-\xi)^2+y^2}}{(x-\tau)^2+y^2+\xi\tau}\,, \tag{30}$$

$$\beta = -\frac{\sqrt{x^2+y^2}\sqrt{(x-\tau)^2+y^2}+\tau\sqrt{(x-\tau-\xi)^2+y^2}}{(x-\tau)^2+y^2+\xi\tau}\,, \tag{31}$$

with τ and ξ fixed as constants. The α- and β-constant curves are ovals that share the same three foci. For this reason, they are called *triconfocal ovals* in this work. It is straightforward to show that these curves intersect at right angles, i.e., that $\nabla\alpha \cdot \nabla\beta = 0$. In Figure **??**, some triconfocal ovals are shown for $\tau = 1$ and $\xi = 1$. The fact that Cartesian ovals with the same three foci meet orthogonally was also noted by Williamson in [12].

To obtain the inverse relations, $x = x(\alpha, \beta)$ and $y = y(\alpha, \beta)$, it is convenient to note that

$$\alpha + \beta = -\frac{2rr'}{\xi\tau + r'^2}\,, \tag{32}$$

$$\alpha\beta = \frac{-\xi\tau - \tau^2 + r^2}{\xi\tau + r'^2}\,. \tag{33}$$

From equation 32, one obtains $r = -(\alpha+\beta)(\xi\tau + r'^2)/2r'$. Substituting this expression for r into equation 33 and reorganizing yields

$$(\beta-\alpha)^2 r'^4 + 2\left(-2\tau + \xi\left(\alpha^2+\beta^2-2\right)\right)\tau r'^2 + \xi^2\tau^2(\alpha+\beta)^2 = 0\,. \tag{34}$$

The solutions to this quadratic equation in $r'^2 \equiv \mu$ are

$$\mu_\pm = \frac{2\tau^2 + \left(2-\alpha^2-\beta^2\right)\xi\tau \pm 2\sqrt{\tau^2\left(\beta^2\xi-\tau-\xi\right)\left(\alpha^2\xi-\tau-\xi\right)}}{(\beta-\alpha)^2}\,. \tag{35}$$

Since $\mu_+ - \mu_- = 4\sqrt{\tau^2\left(\beta^2\xi-\tau-\xi\right)\left(\alpha^2\xi-\tau-\xi\right)}/(\beta-\alpha)^2 > 0$, it follows that $\mu_+ > \mu_-$. Thus, one solution yields an oval larger than the other. The substitution $r'^2 = \mu_\pm$ yields

$$\begin{aligned} x = \Big[&\pm(\alpha\beta-1)\sqrt{\tau^2\left(\beta^2\xi-\tau-\xi\right)\left(\alpha^2\xi-\tau-\xi\right)} \\ &- \left[\left(1-\alpha^2+\alpha\beta-\beta^2\right)\tau + \xi\left(\alpha^2-1\right)\left(\beta^2-1\right)\right]\tau\Big]\frac{1}{(\beta-\alpha)^2\tau}\,, \end{aligned} \tag{36}$$

$$y^2 = -\left(\xi\tau(\alpha\beta-1) - \tau^2 \mp \sqrt{\tau^2\left(\beta^2\xi-\tau-\xi\right)\left(\alpha^2\xi-\tau-\xi\right)}\right)^2 \frac{\left(\alpha^2-1\right)\left(\beta^2-1\right)}{(\beta-\alpha)^4\tau^2}\,, \tag{37}$$

where the equations $x = (r^2+\tau^2-r'^2)/(2\tau)$ and $y^2 = r^2 - (r^2+\tau^2-r'^2)^2/(4\tau^2)$, derived from the definitions of r and r' in terms of x and y, were considered.

Two important topics are left to be discussed in this section. On one hand, since triconfocal ovals have two free parameters τ and ξ,

1. *Triconfocal ovals as confocal Pascal limaçons*

The coordinates just defined are indeed a family of coordinates that depend on τ and ξ. Some interesting cases are $\xi = 0$ and $\xi = -\tau$, with τ being any nonzero real number. For these cases, the corresponding ovals became limaçons of Pascal.

This can be seen as follows. For $\xi = 0$, one has $\alpha = (-r+\tau)/r'$. By the law of cosines, $r = \sqrt{r'^2+\tau^2+2r'\tau\cos\phi}$, see Fig. 5. Hence, one can find

$$r' = \frac{2\tau}{\alpha^2-1}(\cos\phi + \alpha)\,, \tag{38}$$

which is the equation of a limaçon in its standard form. Anagously for β, one finds $r' = \frac{2\tau}{\beta^2-1}(\cos\phi - \beta)$. Therefore, α- and β-constant curves are limaçons. For $\xi = -\tau$, one can

proceed as before to find $r_\pm = \frac{2a\tau}{1-a^2}(\pm 1 - a\cos\theta)$, where the case r_+ is for $a = \alpha$ and the case r_- is for $a = \beta$. Hence, triconfocal oval coordinates can be reduced to *Pascal limaçon coordinates*. As far as the authors of this article knows, coordinates of this kind, with limaçons as constant curves, have not been constructed before.

For $\xi = 0$, equations 36 and 37 become $x = \tau$ and $y^2 = 0$ for the second sign. Since this is inconsistent, one must take the first sign instead. By doing so, one gets

$$x = \frac{\tau(\alpha^2 + \beta^2 - 2)}{(\beta - \alpha)^2}\,, \tag{39}$$

$$y^2 = -\frac{4\tau^2(\alpha^2 - 1)(\beta^2 - 1)}{(\beta - \alpha)^4}\,. \tag{40}$$

This case may be considered as the simplest case of triconfocal oval coordinates.

2. *Existence condition for triconfocal ovals*

Finally, viewing α and β as functions of x, y, ξ, and τ one finds that

$$\beta(x, y; \xi, \tau) = \alpha(-x, -y; -\xi, -\tau)\,, \tag{41}$$

$$\alpha(\tau x, \tau y; \tau\xi, \tau) = \begin{cases} \alpha(x, y; \xi, 1)\,, & \text{if } \tau > 0; \\ \beta(x, y; \xi, 1)\,, & \text{if } \tau < 0\,. \end{cases} \tag{42}$$

By analysing $\alpha(x, y; \xi, 1)$ and $\beta(x, y; \xi, 1)$, viewed as functions of x and y, one can find the range of values that α and β can take in the inverse relations (equations 36 and 37). Let $\mathcal{D}_\alpha$ and $\mathcal{D}_\beta$ be such set of values so that $\alpha \in \mathcal{D}_\alpha$ and $\beta \in \mathcal{D}_\beta$. Then, it is found that $\mathcal{D}_\alpha$ is $[-1, 1]$, if $\tau > 0$ and $\frac{\xi}{\tau} > -1$; $[-1, f\left(\frac{\xi}{\tau}\right)]$, if $\tau > 0$ and $\frac{\xi}{\tau} \leq -1$; $(-\infty, -1] \cup [1, \infty)$, if $\tau < 0$ and $\frac{\xi}{\tau} < 0$; $(-\infty, -1]$ if $\tau < 0$ and $\frac{\xi}{\tau} = 0$; and $[-f\left(\frac{\xi}{\tau}\right), -1]$, if $\tau > 0$ and $\frac{\xi}{\tau} > 0$, where

$$f(\xi) = \frac{(\xi + 1)\left(\sqrt{\xi(1+\xi)} - \xi\right)}{\xi\left(\xi + 1 - \sqrt{\xi(1+\xi)}\right)}\,, \tag{43}$$

is the value of $\alpha(x, y; \xi, 1)$ at $x = x_0$ and $y = 0$, with x_0 being so that $\frac{\partial\alpha(x,0)}{\partial x}\Big|_{x=x_0} = 0$ and $x_0 > 0$. Expressing the specific set $\mathcal{D}_\alpha$ for certain ξ and τ as $\mathcal{D}_\alpha(\xi, \tau)$, one has $\mathcal{D}_\beta(\xi, \tau) = \mathcal{D}_\alpha(-\xi, -\tau)$.

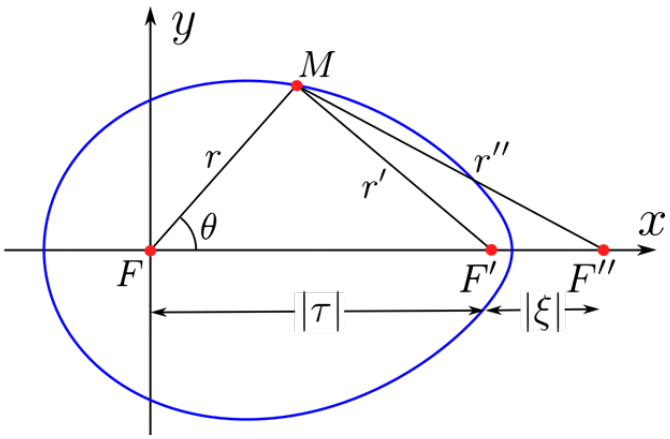


FIG. 5: A Cartesian oval shown on the xy-coordinate system used in Section II. The equation of the oval is $r + ar' = u$, with $a = 0.6$ and $u = 1.1$. The focal distances are $\tau = 1$ and $\xi \simeq 0.36$.

IV. CHARACTERIZATION OF THE VARIOUS ORTHOGONAL COORDINATES

Consider the rectangular Cartesian coordinates x, y in the xy-plane. Any two coordinates q^1, q^2, related to the rectangular ones by the equations $x = x(q^1, q^2)$ and $y = y(q^1, q^2)$, are said to be orthogonal if their metric coefficients,

$$g_{ij} = \frac{\partial \mathbf{r}}{\partial q^i} \cdot \frac{\partial \mathbf{r}}{\partial q^j}\,, \tag{44}$$

form a diagonal matrix, where $\mathbf{r} = x(q^1, q^2)\hat{\boldsymbol{\imath}} + y(q^1, q^2)\hat{\boldsymbol{\jmath}}$ is the position vector of the point (x, y) in the xy-plane and $\hat{\boldsymbol{\imath}}, \hat{\boldsymbol{\jmath}}$ are the unitary Cartesian vectors. It is not difficult to see that the orthogonality condition for q^1, q^2 is

$$x_{,1}x_{,2} + y_{,1}y_{,2} = 0\,, \tag{45}$$

where the subscripts indicate partial differentiation, $x_{,i} := \partial x/\partial q^i$ for each $i = 1, 2$.

This condition is equivalent to say that the q-constant curves, called the coordinate curves, intersect each other at right angles, as it is shown in the appendix VIII. Hence, to construct a 2D system of coordinates, it is sufficient to have a pair of uniparametric families of curves $\mathscr{F}_1 = \{\gamma_r\}_{r\in\mathcal{I}}$ and $\mathscr{F}_2 = \{\sigma_s\}_{s\in\mathcal{J}}$ so that if $\gamma \in \mathscr{F}_1$ and $\sigma \in \mathscr{F}_2$ then γ and σ meet at right angles. The parameters of these two families r, s may be taken as the q^i-coordinates. Naturally, to any point in the xy-plane must pass one and only one member of each family.

If, in addition, these families $\mathscr{F}_1, \mathscr{F}_2$ can be seen as the level curves of two functions f, g, respectively, then $r = f(x, y)$ and $s = g(x, y)$ are the relations between Cartesian and

rs-coordinates. Their inversion, $x = x(r,s), y = y(r,s)$, would allow to compute the metric coefficients in terms of r and s. To construct *oval* coordinates, one may consider that one, or both, of the coordinate curves are ovals. In the next sections, two special families of ovals are considered: confocal ovals and triconfocal ovals. With them, various orthogonal coordinates will be built.

Confocal and triconfocal ovals induced certain systems of coordinates in which the coordinate curves are one of these class of ovals. In this section we will characterize these coordinates in terms of their metric coefficients and their basis vectors. From the methods mentioned in [27], 3D coordinates will be constructed from the 2D coordinates by "rotating" or "translating" the coordinates. This process results in cylindrical- and rotational-like coordinates, respectively.

Consider confocal ovals as u-constant curves and synecdolas as v-constant ones. The quantities u and v define a set of *confocal oval 2D coordinates*, or simply *oval coordinates*. The metric coefficients are described in terms of the functions $x(u,v) \equiv \Lambda(u,v)$ and $y(u,v) \equiv \Upsilon(u,v)$ as

$$ds^2 = \left(\Lambda_u^2 + \Upsilon_u^2\right)\left(du^2 + \Upsilon^2 dv^2\right), \tag{46}$$

where the subscripts indicates partial differentiation. These function satisfy the relations

$$\Lambda_u = -\frac{\sqrt{\Lambda^2+\Upsilon^2}\,a\,(\tau-\Lambda) - \Lambda\sqrt{(\Lambda-\tau)^2+\Upsilon^2}}{2a\left(\Lambda^2+\Upsilon^2-\Lambda\tau\right) + \left(a^2+1\right)\sqrt{\Lambda^2+\Upsilon^2}\sqrt{(\Lambda-\tau)^2+\Upsilon^2}}, \tag{47}$$

$$\Upsilon_u = \frac{\Upsilon\left(\sqrt{\Lambda^2+\Upsilon^2}\,a + \sqrt{(\Lambda-\tau)^2+\Upsilon^2}\right)}{2a\left(\Lambda^2+\Upsilon^2-\Lambda\tau\right) + \left(a^2+1\right)\sqrt{\Lambda^2+\Upsilon^2}\sqrt{(\Lambda-\tau)^2+\Upsilon^2}}, \tag{48}$$

$$\Lambda_v = \Upsilon\Upsilon_u\,, \tag{49}$$

$$\Upsilon_v = -\Upsilon\Lambda_u\,, \tag{50}$$

which can be obtained by taking partial differentiation to the equations $u = \sqrt{x^2+y^2} + a\sqrt{(x-\tau)^2+y^2}$ and $v = \operatorname{arcsinh}(x/y) + a\operatorname{arcsinh}((x-\tau)/y)$, which define u and v in terms of x and y. In addition, the basis vectors related to u and v are

$$\hat{\boldsymbol{e}}_u = \frac{1}{\sqrt{\Lambda_u^2+\Upsilon_u^2}}\left(\Lambda_u\hat{\boldsymbol{e}}_x + \Upsilon_u\hat{\boldsymbol{e}}_y\right), \tag{51}$$

$$\hat{\boldsymbol{e}}_v = \frac{1}{\sqrt{\Lambda_u^2+\Upsilon_u^2}}\left(\Upsilon_u\hat{\boldsymbol{e}}_x - \Lambda_u\hat{\boldsymbol{e}}_y\right). \tag{52}$$

Another system of coordinates may be derived from triconfocal ovals. The quantities α and β, defined in the previous section, are consider as a set of *triconfocal oval 2D coordinates*, or *triconfocal coordinates* for short. In this case, the metric coefficients are given by

$$ds^2 = g_{\alpha\alpha}\left(d\alpha^2 + \frac{(\alpha^2-1)(\alpha^2\xi-\tau-\xi)}{(1-\beta^2)(\beta^2\xi-\tau-\xi)}d\beta^2\right), \tag{53}$$

with

$$g_{\alpha\alpha} = \Big[2\left(-\alpha\beta\xi+\tau+\xi\right)\sqrt{\tau^2\left(\beta^2\xi-\tau-\xi\right)\left(\alpha^2\xi-\tau-\xi\right)} + \big(2\left(\alpha^2\beta^2+1\right)\xi - \left(\beta+\alpha\right)^2\left(\xi+\tau\right) - 4\tau\big)\xi\tau + 2\tau^3\Big]\frac{\beta+\alpha}{\left(\alpha^2-1\right)\left(\beta-\alpha\right)^3\left(\alpha^2\xi-\tau-\xi\right)}. \tag{54}$$

The basis vectors are ... In the case $\xi = 0$, this coordinates get reduced to Pascal limaçon coordinates, whose metric coefficients are given by

$$ds^2 = \frac{4(\alpha+\beta)\tau^2}{(\alpha-\beta)^3}\left(\frac{1}{\alpha^2-1}d\alpha^2 + \frac{1}{1-\beta^2}d\beta^2\right). \tag{55}$$

Based on the two set of coordinates described before, one can easily obtain cylindrical-like coordinates. For this one just needs to introduce a z coordinate in the orthogonal direction to the xy-plane in which the 2D coordinate curves live. Hence, one obtains *confocal oval-cylinder coordinates* u, v and z, and *triconfocal oval-cylinder coordinates* α, β and z. Their line elements are respectively

$$ds^2 = \left(\Lambda_u^2 + \Upsilon_u^2\right)\left(du^2 + \Upsilon^2 dv^2\right) + dz^2, \tag{56}$$

$$ds^2 = g_{\alpha\alpha}\left(d\alpha^2 + \frac{(\alpha^2-1)(\alpha^2\xi-\tau-\xi)}{(1-\beta^2)(\beta^2\xi-\tau-\xi)}d\beta^2\right) + dz^2. \tag{57}$$

It should be pointed out that the Laplace equation admits a separable solution for the triconfocal oval-cylinder coordinates, but not for the confocal ones.

Next, rotational coordinates can be obtained in the next way. Consider a point $(x(q^1,q^2), y(q^1,q^2), 0)$ in some xyz-space related to coordinates q^1 and q^2. Rotate this point around either the x- or y-axis in a certain angle ϕ. The set of points obtained by fixing one of the quantities q^1, q^2 and ϕ define a certain surface. The resulting classes of surfaces orthogonally intersect each other and define the coordinate surfaces of certain system of coordinates. Naturally, it only make sense to rotate the points around the symmetry axis of the coordinate 2D curves. For ovals, this coincides with the focal axis.

Applying this to confocal ovals, one obtains the coordinates

$$\tilde{u} = \sqrt{x^2+y^2+z^2} + a\sqrt{x^2+y^2+(z-\tau)^2}\,, \tag{58}$$

$$\tilde{v} = \operatorname{arcsinh}\left(\frac{z}{\sqrt{x^2+y^2}}\right) + a\operatorname{arcsinh}\left(\frac{z-\tau}{\sqrt{x^2+y^2}}\right)\,, \tag{59}$$

$$\phi = \operatorname{atan2}(y,x)\,, \tag{60}$$

with inverse relations $x = \Upsilon(\tilde{u},\tilde{v})\cos\phi$, $y = \Upsilon(\tilde{u},\tilde{v})\sin\phi$ and $z = \Lambda(\tilde{u},\tilde{v})$. The corresponding line element is

$$ds^2 = \left(\Lambda_{\tilde{u}}^2 + \Upsilon_{\tilde{u}}^2\right)\left(d\tilde{u}^2 + \Upsilon^2 d\tilde{v}^2\right) + \Upsilon^2 d\phi^2\,. \tag{61}$$

One can check that $\tilde{u}-$ and $\tilde{v}-$constant surfaces are surfaces of revolution of their respective coordinate curves around the symmetry axis. Since the surface of revolution of ovals are known as ovoids, this coordinates may be called as *confocal ovoid 3D coordinates*, or simply as *ovoid coordinates*. In the same spirit, the term *synecdoloids* is coined to refer to the $\tilde{v}$-constant surfaces, in analogy to the one used for the surface of revolution of hyperbolas. The line element 61 is the one that will be use in the next section to construct stationary spacetimes with ovoid symmetry.

Finally, for triconfocal oval coordinates one obtains

$$\tilde{\alpha} = \frac{-\sqrt{z^2+x^2+y^2}\sqrt{(z-\tau)^2+x^2+y^2} + \tau\sqrt{(z-\tau-\xi)^2+x^2+y^2}}{(z-\tau)^2+x^2+y^2+\xi\tau}\,, \tag{62}$$

$$\tilde{\beta} = -\frac{\sqrt{z^2+x^2+y^2}\sqrt{(z-\tau)^2+x^2+y^2} + \tau\sqrt{(z-\tau-\xi)^2+x^2+y^2}}{(z-\tau)^2+x^2+y^2+\xi\tau}\,. \tag{63}$$

$$\phi = \operatorname{atan2}(y,x)\,, \tag{64}$$

with the inverse relations $x = \kappa(\tilde{\alpha},\tilde{\beta})\cos\phi$, $y = \kappa(\tilde{\alpha},\tilde{\beta})\sin\phi$ and $z = \eta(\tilde{\alpha},\tilde{\beta})$, where $\eta(\alpha,\beta)$ is taken to be the right hand side of the equation 36 and $\kappa(\alpha,\beta)$ is taken to be the square root of the right hand side of the equation 37. The quantity ϕ takes values in the interval $[0,2\pi)$, and as in the previous section $\tilde{\alpha}\in\mathcal{D}_{\tilde{\alpha}}$ and $\tilde{\beta}\in\mathcal{D}_{\tilde{\beta}}$. The line element is

$$ds^2 = g_{\tilde{\alpha}\tilde{\alpha}}\left(d\tilde{\alpha}^2 + \frac{(\tilde{\alpha}^2-1)(\tilde{\alpha}^2\xi-\tau-\xi)}{(1-\tilde{\beta}^2)(\tilde{\beta}^2\xi-\tau-\xi)}d\tilde{\beta}^2\right) + \kappa^2 d\phi^2\,. \tag{65}$$

This coordinates may be called as *triconfocal ovoid 3D coordinates*.

V. OVOID SPACETIMES

The symmetries in a spacetime are usually characterized by geometric invariants such as Killing vectors. These vector can be associated to a group of isometries isomorphic to a certain group such as $SO(2)$ or $SO(3)$. In this sense, it is natural to define an axially symmetric spacetime or a spherically symmetric spacetime as one in which there is a subgroup G of the group of isometries[2] which is isomorphic to $SO(2)$ or $SO(3)$, respectively. However, for other spacetimes such as ellipsoidal or ovoid spacetimes, there is not such a natural definition since there is not a group related to ellipsoids or ovoids. The best one can do is to propose a metric ansatz that encapsulates some desirable features. One of such may be that, for example, there exits some congruence of observers in which the induced metric over their orthogonal hypersurfaces resembles or be similar to the metric over ellipsoids or ovoids. Such proposal is the one of Krasiński [18], which construct an stationary oblate-ellipsoidal metric ansatz. Here, a stationary ovoid metric ansatz will be built based on the same procedure.

In order to do that, consider a congruence of observers characterized by the four-velocity $w = U\partial_t + V\partial_\phi$. As the spacetime is consider to be stationary and axially symmetric, there exist two conmuting killing vector fields, which here are considered as ∂_t and ∂_ϕ. The

TABLE I: Orthogonal coordinates. $\mathcal{D}_u$ is given by the equation **??** and $\mathcal{D}_\alpha$ and $\mathcal{D}_\beta$ are described in Section III B. For the Pascal limaçon coordinates it was made $\alpha \equiv \mu$ and $\beta \equiv \nu$.

System of coordinates	Coordinates	Conditions		
Confocal oval coordinates	u, v	$u \in \mathcal{D}_u$	$v \in \mathbb{R}$	
Confocal oval-cylinder coordinates	u, v, z	$u \in \mathcal{D}_u$	$v \in \mathbb{R}$	$z \in \mathbb{R}$
Confocal ovoid coordinates	$\tilde{u}, \tilde{v}, \phi$	$\tilde{u} \in \mathcal{D}_u$	$\tilde{v} \in \mathbb{R}$	$\phi \in [0, 2\pi)$
Triconfocal oval coordinates	α, β	$\alpha \in \mathcal{D}_\alpha$	$\beta \in \mathcal{D}_\beta$	
Pascal limaçon coordinates	μ, ν	$\mu \in [-1, 1]$	$\nu \in (-\infty, -1]$	
Triconfocal oval-cylinder coordinates	α, β, z	$\alpha \in \mathcal{D}_\alpha$	$\beta \in \mathcal{D}_\beta$	$z \in \mathbb{R}$
Triconfocal ovoid coordinates	$\tilde{\alpha}, \tilde{\beta}, \phi$	$\tilde{\alpha} \in \mathcal{D}_\alpha$	$\tilde{\beta} \in \mathcal{D}_\beta$	$\phi \in [0, 2\pi)$

[2] $\mathrm{Iso}(M, \mathcal{G}) := \{\phi : M \to M \mid \phi^* \mathcal{G} = \mathcal{G}\}$ endowed with the composition operation, where M is the manifold, $\mathcal{G}$ is the metric tensor and ϕ^* is the pushforward of ϕ.

projection of the metric tensor over the orthogonal hypersurfaces of w is taken as

$$(g_{ab}+w_a w_b)dx^a\otimes dx^b = f^2(\Lambda_u^2+\Upsilon_u^2)du\otimes du+k^2\left[\Upsilon^2(\Lambda_u^2+\Upsilon_u^2)dv\otimes dv+\Upsilon^2 d\Phi\otimes d\Phi\right]\,, \quad (66)$$

where f and k are functions of u and v, and $d\Phi = d\phi-(V/U)dt$. From here one can deduce the most general form of a metric tensor that satisfies the equation 66, which is

$$\begin{aligned}\mathcal{G} = g_{00}dt\otimes dt + g_{03}(dt\otimes d\phi + d\phi\otimes dt) + A^2 d\phi\otimes d\phi + f^2(\Lambda_u^2+\Upsilon_u^2)du\otimes du \\ + k^2\Upsilon^2(\Lambda_u^2+\Upsilon_u^2)dv\otimes dv\,. \end{aligned} \quad (67)$$

Over the 2-surfaces spanned by the vectors ∂_v and ∂_ϕ, the induced metric is conformal to that of an ovoid (see equation 61). To simplify the notation, the tilde emphasis in u and v has been omitted. Equation 66 shows that there is a part of the induced metric that is conformal to the metric over confocal ovoids, with k^2 being the conformal factor. The same procedure describe before can be implemented to derive a triconfocal ovoid metric ansatz $\mathcal{G}'$. For simplicity, this article focus only on this confocal case. Now it is convenient to write the static case of the metric $\mathcal{G}$ because it will be useful later. This corresponds to the metric

$$\mathcal{G}_{static} = g_{00}dt\otimes dt + k^2\Upsilon^2 d\phi\otimes d\phi + f^2(\Lambda_u^2+\Upsilon_u^2)du\otimes du + k^2\Upsilon^2(\Lambda_u^2+\Upsilon_u^2)dv\otimes dv\,. \quad (68)$$

It should be mention that by considering the equations 47 and 48 to write Λ_u and Υ_u in terms of $\Lambda = z$ and $\Upsilon = \sqrt{x^2+y^2}$ and by fixing $a = 0$ or $\tau = 0$, $\mathcal{G}_{static}$ in spherical coordinates is reduced to

$$\mathcal{G}_{spheric} = g_{00}dt\otimes dt + k^2r^2\sin^2\theta\, d\phi\otimes d\phi + f^2 dr\otimes dr + k^2r^2 d\theta\otimes d\theta\,. \quad (69)$$

which is a suitable metric ansatz to describe static spherically symmetric spacetimes. Hence, the *ovoid spacetimes* here described have the spherically symmetric spacetimes as a particular case. The condition $a = 0$ or $\tau = 0$ makes the u-constant surfaces in the ovoid coordinate system become concentric spheres to the origin with radius $r = u$ or $r = u/(1+a)$, respectively.

VI. ANISOTROPIC FLUID SOLUTIONS TO THE EINSTEIN FIELD EQUATIONS

The relevance to define spacetimes with new symmetries is that it opens the possibility to obtain new exact solutions to the Einstein field equations. If it is a vacuum solution,

it can be interpreted as the solution for a black hole ore one part of it can be interpreted as the external solution for an object with ovoid symmetry. And, if it is a fluid solution, one would obtain a model for the gravitational field inside an object with ovoid symmetry. Both cases are very interesting and stimulating. Sadly, the Einstein field equations get too complicated. For this article, only a static anisotropic fluid solution is obtained.

Consider a static ovoid spacetime govern by the metric $\mathcal{G}_{static}$. A suitable stress-energy tensor for an static anisotropic fluid is

$$\mathcal{T} = T^{ab}\partial_a \otimes \partial_b = (\mu + P_1)w \otimes w + P_1\mathcal{G}^{-1}_{static} + (P_2 - P_1)e_2 \otimes e_2 + (P_3 - P_1)e_3 \otimes e_3\,, \quad (70)$$

where w is the four-velocity of the fluid, μ is its mass-energy density, P_i is its pressure in the direction of e_i with $i = 1, 2, 3$, $\{e_\mu\} = \{w, e_1, e_2, e_3\}$ is the orthonormal tetrad of the observer with four-velocity w, and $\mathcal{G}^{-1}_{static}$ is the inverse metric. Naturally, the quantities μ and P_i are the ones measured by the comoving observer with the fluid. In the case $P_2 = P_3 = P_1$ one recovers the stress-energy tensor of a perfect fluid in its standard form. In natural units the Einstein field equations are

$$R_{ab} = 8\pi\left(T_{ab} - \frac{1}{2}Tg_{ab}\right)\,, \quad (71)$$

where T is the trace of $\mathcal{T}$ and $\mathcal{R} = R_{ab}\,dx^a \otimes dx^b$ is the Ricci tensor.

A solution to this equations is given by

$$P_1 = \frac{1}{8\pi\Upsilon^2(\Lambda_u^2 + \Upsilon_u^2)^2}\left(\mathcal{P} - A_u^2\Upsilon^2(\Lambda_u^2 + \Upsilon_u^2)e^{-2B}\right)\,, \quad (72)$$

$$P_2 = \frac{1}{8\pi\Upsilon^2(\Lambda_u^2 + \Upsilon_u^2)^2}\left\{\mathcal{L} - \left[(A_u + B_u)\Upsilon_u - A_u^2\Upsilon\right](\Lambda_u^2 + \Upsilon_u^2)\Upsilon e^{-2B}\right\}\,, \quad (73)$$

$$P_3 = \frac{1}{8\pi\Upsilon^2(\Lambda_u^2 + \Upsilon_u^2)^3}\left\{\mathcal{Q} + \left[A_u^2\Upsilon^2(\Lambda_u^2 + \Upsilon_u^2) - \mathcal{L}\right](\Lambda_u^2 + \Upsilon_u^2)e^{-2B}\right\}\,, \quad (74)$$

$$\mu = \frac{1}{8\pi\Upsilon^2(\Lambda_u^2 + \Upsilon_u^2)^3}\Big\{ - \mathcal{Q} + \Big[2\Upsilon^2 A_{uu} + (B_u + 5A_u)\Upsilon\Upsilon_u - A_u\Upsilon^2(2B_u + 3A_u) + \mathcal{P}\Big](\Lambda_u^2 + \Upsilon_u^2)^2 e^{-2B}\Big\}\,, \quad (75)$$

$$g_{00} = e^{2A}\,, \quad (76)$$

$$f = e^{2B}\,, \quad (77)$$

$$k = e^{2(c_1 - A)}\,, \quad (78)$$

where A and B are arbitrary functions of u, c_1 is a constant, and $\mathcal{P}$, $\mathcal{Q}$ and $\mathcal{L}$ are given by

$$\mathcal{P} = \Upsilon_u \left(\Upsilon_{uv}\Lambda_u - \Lambda_{uv}\Upsilon_u\right)\left(e^{2(A-c_1)} - e^{-2B}\right), \tag{79}$$

$$\begin{aligned}\mathcal{Q} = &\left[(\Lambda_u^2 - \Upsilon_u^2)(\Upsilon_{uv}^2 + \Lambda_{uv}^2) + (\Lambda_u\Lambda_{uvv} + \Upsilon_u\Upsilon_{uvv})(\Lambda_u^2 + \Upsilon_u^2) - 4\Lambda_u\Upsilon_u\Lambda_{uv}\Upsilon_{uv}\right] \\ &\times \left(e^{2(A-c_1)} - e^{-2B}\right) + (A_u + B_u)(\Lambda_u^2 + \Upsilon_u^2)(\Lambda_u\Upsilon_{uv} - \Upsilon_u\Lambda_{uv})\Upsilon e^{-2B}, \end{aligned} \tag{80}$$

$$\mathcal{L} = \Lambda_u \left(\Lambda_{uv}\Lambda_u + \Upsilon_{uv}\Upsilon_u\right)\left(e^{-2B} - e^{2(A-c_1)}\right), \tag{81}$$

In order to check that this solutions satisfies the equation 71 it is convenient to use the relations shown in Section VIII C to simplify the expressions that involve derivatives of Λ and Υ. In this scenario, the weak and strong energy conditions can be satisfied if $\mu, P_i \geq 0$. In the limit when $x, y, z \gg \tau$ this inequalities take the approximate form

$$uA_u^2 - (A_u + B_u) \geq 0, \tag{82}$$

$$1 - e^{2(A+B-c_1)} - u^2A_u^2 \geq 0, \tag{83}$$

$$2A_u - uA_uB_u + uA_{uu} - uA_u^2 \geq 0. \tag{84}$$

These were obtained by expressing the derivatives of Λ and Υ in terms of themselves (see the appendix VIII C) and taking the high order terms in x, y and z. A solution to the exact or the approximate energy conditions is left for a future work.

VII. CONCLUSIONS

[1] A. Silva-Lora and R. Torres. Explicit cartesian oval as a superconic surface for stigmatic imaging optical systems with real or virtual source or image. *Proceedings of the Royal Society A: Mathematical, Physical and Engineering Sciences*, 476(2235):20190894, 2020.

[2] R. Descartes. *Discours de la méthode pour bien conduire sa raison et chercher la vérité dans les sciences, with three appendices: La Dioptrique (Les Météores, andLaGéométrie)*. Leyden, 1637.

[3] J. P. Southall. Aplanatic (or Cartesian) optical surfaces. *Journal of the Franklin Institute*, 193(5):609–626, 1922.

[4] A. Silva-Lora and R. Torres. Aplanatism in stigmatic optical systems. *Optics Letters*, 45(23):6390–6393, 2020.

[5] A. Silva-Lora and R. Torres. Rigorously aplanatic descartes ovoids. *J. Opt. Soc. Am. A*, 38(8):1160–1169, 2021.

[6] A. Silva-Lora and R. Torres. Achromatic stigmatism: achromatic cartesian ovoid. *J. Opt. Soc. Am. A*, 39(9):1524–1532, 2022.

[7] A. W. Greynolds. Superconic and subconic surface descriptions in optical design. In *International Optical Design Conference*. Optical Society of America, Optica Publishing Group, 2002.

[8] S. Cho. Explicit superconic curves. *J. Opt. Soc. Am. A*, 33(9):1822–1830, 2016.

[9] A. Silva-Lora and R. Torres. Superconical aplanatic ovoid singlet lenses. *J. Opt. Soc. Am. A*, 37(7):1155–1165, 2020.

[10] K. Schwarzschild. Untersuchungen zur geometrischen Optik II. *Astronomische Mittheilungen der Königlichen Sternwarte zu Göttingen*, 10:3–28, 1905.

[11] M. Chasles. *Aperçu historique sur l'origine et le développement des méthodes en géométrie*. Mém. couronnés, Acad. des sci. et belles lett. de Bruxelles. M. Hayez, Imprimeur de l'académie royale, 1837.

[12] B. Williamson. *An Elementary Treatise on the Differential Calculus: Containing the Theory of Plane Curves, with Numerous Examples*. Longmans, Green, and co., 1912. New impression.

[13] W. W. Johnson. Bipolar equations - cartesian ovals. *The Analyst*, 2(4):106–115, 1875.

[14] K. Schwarzschild. Über das gravitationsfeld einer kugel aus inkompressibler flüssigkeit nach der einsteinschen theorie. *Sitzungsberichte der königlich preußischen Akademie der Wissenschaften zu Berlin*, pages 424–434, 1916.

[15] R. C. Tolman. Static solutions of einstein's field equations for spheres of fluid. *Physical Review*, 55(4):364, 1939.

[16] H. D. Wahlquist. Interior solution for a finite rotating body of perfect fluid. *Physical Review*, 172(5):1291, 1968.

[17] F. J. Chinea and L. M. González-Romero. Interior gravitational field of a stationary, axially symmetric perfect fluid in irrotational motion. *Classical and Quantum Gravity*, 7(5):L99, 1990.

[18] A. Krasiński. Ellipsoidal space-times, sources for the kerr metric. *Annals of Physics*, 112(1):22–40, 1978.

[19] I. Racz. Note on stationary-axisymmetric vacuum spacetimes with inside ellipsoidal symmetry. *Classical and Quantum Gravity*, 9(8):L93, 1992.

[20] I. Rácz and M. Süveges. On the uniqueness of stationary axisymmetric ellipsoidal vacuum configurations. *Modern Physics Letters A*, 13(14):1101–1107, 1998.

[21] J. Zsigrai. Ellipsoidal shapes in general relativity: general definitions and an application. *Classical and Quantum Gravity*, 20(13):2855, 2003.

[22] C. W. Misner, K. S. Thorne, and J. A. Wheeler. *Gravitation*. Princeton University Press, 2017.

[23] H. Stephani, D. Kramer, M. MacCallum, C. Hoenselaers, and E. Herlt. *Exact Solutions of Einstein's Field Equations*. Cambridge Monographs on Mathematical Physics. Cambridge University Press, 2 edition, 2003.

[24] A. Quetelet. *Correspondance mathématique et physique*, volume 5. M. Hayez, Imprimeur de L'Académie Royale, 1829.

[25] R. Ferréol. Cartesian Oval. (website). https://mathcurve.com/courbes2d.gb/descartes/descartes.shtml (accessed: 07.30.2026).

[26] B. Williamson. *An Elementary Treatise on the Differential Calculus: Containing the Theory of Plane Curves, with Numerous Examples*, chapter XX On the Cartesian Oval, pages 375–384. Longmans, Green, and co., 1912.

[27] P. H. Moon and D. E. Spencer. *Field Theory Handbook: Including Coordinate Systems, Differential Equations, and Their Solutions*. John T. Zubal, 1988.

VIII. APPENDIX

A. The s-equation as an algebraic equation in some power of s

B. r_1 is the positive solution to the s-equation for $a = 1/3$

C. Characterization of the second and third derivatives of the metric functions Λ and Υ